

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1998-05-23

To the bahá'ís of Slovakia

dearly loved friends,

The emergence of the independent National Spiritual Assembly of the bahá'ís of Slovakia at the midpoint of the four year plan is a cause of rejoicing for the whole bahá'í world. it is the fruit of the self-sacrificing endeavors of the devoted believers, whether pioneers or native czechs and Slovaks, who have raised up so many soundly based, spiritually motivated bahá'í communities in the course of the past decade. And looking further back still, we see the foundations of these achievements in the travels of out-standing bahá'í teachers such as martha root, in the extraordinary response of leading czechoslovak statesmen to the Teachings of bahá'u'lláh, and in the heroic steadfastness of the early believers who kept alive the spark of the faith through so many dark years of suffering.

you stand now on the threshold of challenging new developments in which you will contribute your special qualities to the advancement of the cause of god in europe as your national bahá'í community grows in the number and diversity of believers and in the strength of its institutions.

it is our fervent prayer in the holy Shrines that the Slovak bahá'í community, in close collaboration with the communities of the czech republic, Austria, hungary, poland, romania, and the ukraine, will become a shining light in the heart of the european continent, shedding far and wide the illumination of the message of bahá'u'lláh.

with loving bahá'í greetings,

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message from The Universal House of Justice

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Deputization of Institute Teachers

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]